

Viacheslav Popkov

3D artist | Industrial designer | 3D printing specialist

📍 Yekaterinburg, Russia (Open to Remote, Relocation & International Projects)
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Professional Summary

I am a 3D Generalist and Additive Manufacturing Specialist with a strong engineering and production mindset. I bridge the gap between digital 3D art, reverse engineering, physical manufacturing, and education.

What I bring to the table:

- **Game-Ready & Environment Art:** Full pipeline creation for Unity and Unreal Engine — from sculpting and modeling to baking, texturing, and engine integration.
- **Reverse Engineering & CAD:** High-precision 3D scanning, retopology, and custom part design (e.g., automotive tuning and functional components).
- **Additive Manufacturing & CNC:** End-to-end 3D printing workflows (FDM, SLA, SLS) and CNC machining, taking projects from scan/concept to a physical end product.
- **Project Leadership & Impact:** Proven track record of high-impact delivery, including developing a 3D solution that saved a university 10M RUB, delivering 50+ custom commercial projects, and pitching to C-level stakeholders and state officials.
- **Mentorship & Education:** Curriculum development and training in 3D modeling and 3D printing at Russian Railways (RZD).

Core Tech Stack

3D & Sculpting:	Blender, ZBrush, Shapelab, CAD software (KOMPAS 3D), Hard Surface Modeling
Texturing & Rendering:	Substance 3D Painter, Marmoset Toolbag, Adobe Photoshop, PBR Texturing, UV Mapping, Baking (AO, Normal maps)
Game Engines & VR:	Unity, Unreal Engine, VR Optimization, Game-Ready Asset Pipeline
Additive & Hardware:	3D Scanning, Retopology of 3D Scans, FDM / SLA / SLS Printing, CNC Machining (Laser, Milling)
Languages:	English (B1 - Intermediate), Russian (Native), Ukrainian (B1), Czech (A2)

Work Experience

Teacher of Additional Education in 3D Modeling & Printing | Russian Railways (RZD)

January 2026 – Present

- **Education & Curriculum:** Designed and delivered training modules on 3D modeling (Blender/CAD) and 3D printing technologies for students.
- **3D Printing Operations:** Executed end-to-end additive manufacturing (FDM/SLA) workflows to meet internal operational needs for Russian Railways — from 3D model prep/slicing to physical printing and post-processing.
- **Project Mentorship:** Guided student engineering projects, assisting them from initial concept design to final 3D prototype delivery.

- **Equipment Maintenance:** Managed, calibrated, and maintained the studio's 3D printer fleet and software pipeline.
- **Key Achievement:** Produced functional parts and architectural/technical models via 3D printing supporting RZD's internal hardware and visualization needs; trained students in fundamental and advanced 3D modeling skills.

Reverse Engineer & 3D Artist | LedStudio

December 2024 – December 2025

- Operate professional 3D scanning equipment and execute full retopology pipelines on 3D scan data.
- Design custom auto-tuning parts and hard-surface functional components using Blender and CAD software.
- Manage end-to-end additive manufacturing (FDM, SLS 3D printers) and CNC machining (laser, milling cutters).
- Produce high-quality visualizations and product renders for clients.
- **Key Achievement:** Successfully completed 50+ commercial projects, mastering advanced 3D scan retopology and high-precision print preparation workflows.

3D Generalist | Ural Federal University (UrFU)

December 2023 – December 2024

- Executed full 3D pipeline: reference gathering, environment modeling, retopology, UV unwrapping, map baking (AO, Normal), texturing, and engine integration (Unity, Unreal Engine).
- Produced promotional and educational video materials including video editing and graphic integration.
- **Key Achievement:** Developed a high-value 3D project that saved the university **10 Million RUB**. Successfully delivered and pitched project roadmaps directly to the Director of IRIT-RTF, the Rector of UrFU, and the Advisor to the President of the Russian Federation.

Freelance 3D Artist | Upwork

August 2021 – March 2022

- Modeled optimized game-ready environment assets and props for international mobile game developers.
- Created clean UV maps and high-quality renders for product cards and marketing assets.
- Communicated directly with international clients in English, fulfilling strict client specifications and deadlines.

Education

Master's Degree in Software Engineering (2025 – 2027)

Ural Federal University (UrFU), Institute of Radioelectronics and Information Technologies

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science & Information Technology (2021 – 2025)

Ural Federal University (UrFU), Institute of Radioelectronics and Information Technologies